

Disable Thumbnail Caching

One of Explorer's features is to display a thumbnail of images and the first frame of the video when seen in Thumbnail view. Explorer can either create it when you access the folder or fetch it from the thumbnail cache. Fetching thumbnails from the cache is significantly faster, but will consume a lot of hard disk space, especially if your system is chock-full of images and video.

Navigate to:

HCU\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer\Advanced

Set the DWORD Value **DisableThumbnailCache** to 1 if you are low on hard disk space. Otherwise, it makes sense to leave it at zero—the thumbnail cache can indeed be useful.

Load Kernel Into RAM

In Windows 98, programs could be loaded and kept in RAM for as long as you wanted. You could even load a video clip into RAM directly and have it play from there! XP is much more restrictive, mostly due to security reasons. But when it comes to the Windows XP kernel, there's something you can do. By default, XP only loads the required parts of the kernel into RAM at boot time, and calls the other parts as and when needed. Having the entire kernel available in memory speeds up processing.

Navigate to:

HLM\System\CurrentControlSet\Control\Session Manager\Memory Management

Set the value of the **DisablePagingExecutive** key to 1. This will make the entire kernel be loaded in memory. A reboot is required for the changes to take effect.

Name	Type	Data
(ab) (Default)	REG_SZ	(value not set)
(89) DisablePagingExecutive	REG_DWORD	0x00000001 (1)
HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Control\Session ...		